

Xiangyu Wang

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Institutional Affiliation: University of Oxford

Click on Personal Website

Education

- **University of Oxford** — Oxford, UK 10/2024–Present
MPhil in Linguistics, Philology and Phonetics, offering papers in syntax, semantics, psycholinguistics, and computational linguistics.
- **University of Nottingham Ningbo China** — Ningbo, China 09/2020–06/2024
BA in English Language and Applied Linguistics
GPA: 4.0/4.0
- **University of California, Santa Cruz** — Santa Cruz, USA 07/2023–09/2023
Summer Session
Course: Variations in Language Processing
Grade: A+
- **University of Birmingham** — Birmingham, UK 01/2023–06/2023
International Exchange Program
Courses: Language and the Mind, Corpus Linguistics, Research Methods D
GPA: 4.0/4.0

Publications

Wang, Xiangyu. Forthcoming. Mandarin Verb Doubling in Locative and Directional Phrases: Structures in Syntax and Postsyntax In *Proceedings of the 28th Seoul International Conference on Generative Grammar (SICOGG 28)*.

Wang, Xiangyu. Forthcoming. From intensifiers to reflexives: Mandarin *ziji* as an intensifier. In *Proceedings of the 38th North American Conference on Chinese Linguistics (NACCL-38)*.

Presentations and Conferences

Wang, Xiangyu. (2026). Verb-Doubling (VD) in locative and directional types: can they tell us more about Mandarin *zai* 'BE.at' and other verb-prepositions?

The 28th Seoul International Conference on Generative Grammar (SICOGG 28). Daejeon, South Korea. 10–12 August 2026.

Wang, Xiangyu. (2026). Verb-Doubling (VD) in locative and directional types: same derivation?

Oxford Postgraduate Conference in Linguistics (LingO 2026). Oxford, UK. 22–23 June 2026. [Talk]

Wang, Xiangyu. (2026). Why Pre-emption of Reasoning? Intensifier *ziji* as a root.

The 38th North American Conference on Chinese Linguistics (NACCL-38). Washington, D.C., US. 8–10 May 2026. [Talk]

Wang, Xiangyu. (2026). Incremental Focus Processing: a Mandarin case.

Oxford Psycholinguistics Meeting. Oxford, UK. 20 February 2026.

Research Experience

- **Paper** — Verb-Doubling in Mandarin: a PF-driven approach extension to locative and directional types 06/2025–Present
 - *Objective:* To argue for a unified PF-driven approach to all six meaning-based types of verb-doubling (VD).
 - Used VD to probe the syntactic position of locative arguments.

- Demonstrated that Mandarin VP, or its extension below the vP boundary, can be partitioned under the copy theory of movement.

• **Paper** — Why Pre-emption of Reasoning? Intensifier *ziji* as a Root 06/2025–Present

- *Objective*: To develop a theory that incorporates two semantic primitives—intensifier semantics and identity semantics—carried by *ziji* in non-argumental positions, in order to derive different forms of reflexives containing *ziji*.
- Surveyed typological data on forms used reflexively under the clausemate condition.
- Characterized *ziji*'s licensing conditions in head-adjacent and head-distant uses based on Discourse Representation Theory and Mandarin predicate types encoding state change.
- Established a source for *ziji*'s blocking effect while avoiding over-reliance on structural notions inherited from the Binding Principles.

Skills & Qualifications

- Languages: English (fluent), Mandarin Chinese (native), Wu Chinese (native)
- Quantitative (Linguistic) Analysis: AI-enhanced working knowledge of R for mixed-effects models; AI-enhanced Python skills in preprocessing CHAT data (and text data more broadly) and in distributional analysis
- Software: PennController for IBEX for experimental design and execution

Extracurricular Education

- The 7th Crete Summer School of Linguistics
- The NYI Global Institute of Cultural, Cognitive, and Linguistic Studies Virtual NYI #10: Syntax II, Learnability and Linguistic Theory, Weird Types of Movement, Head Movement.
- Birmingham Corpus Linguistics Summer School 2023: Focused on usage-based linguistics with applications in Behavioural Profile, Cluster Analysis, and Machine Learning.
- Leiden Summer School in Language and Linguistics: Specialized in Chinese Dialectology, and mastered software essentials including ELAN, FLEEx, and Praat.
- Truly Global /L+/ Summer/Winter School on Language Acquisition 2023: Participated in lectures, discussions, and practical sessions on lexical and morphosyntactic development.
- The NYI Global Institute of Cultural, Cognitive, and Linguistic Studies: Attended Virtual NYI #5 and #7, covering topics in Formal Semantics/Syntax, Sentence Processing, Chinese Syntax, Phonological Knowledge: The linguistic content of phonemes and phonological features, and Introduction to Morphology.
- International Summer School on Bilingualism and Multilingualism 2022: Studied syntactic comprehension in monolingual and bilingual contexts.